

If you are looking for branded ones, NI has an electronics workbench that comes with schematic capture and circuit simulation software.

If you are the kind of person who prefers mobile devices like a smartphone or tablet rather than a PC, there are many apps available for simulating circuits too. Ones like iCircuit will cost you ₹ 600 in Apple App Store, but it comes with a ton of features including always-on simulation and over 30 elements that can be used to build your circuit.

In addition to these components, the app also features virtual equipment like multimeters and oscilloscopes to read values or track signals. This app is also available on Windows Store, Google Play and as a Windows Phone app.

What next

With most software development

MAJOR CONTRIBUTORS TO THIS REPORT



Jason Guo,
senior technical staff
member, Fairchild
Semiconductor



Dr K.V. Gangadharan,
professor and head of
mechanical engineering,
MITK, Surathkal



Kalyan B. Ram,
co-founder and CEO,
Electrono Solutions
Pvt Ltd



Kiran Kumar S.,
field application
engineer,
Wind River



Rahman Jamal,
global technology &
marketing director,
National Instruments



Satish Mohanram,
technical marketing
manager, National
Instruments

companies going agile, virtual labs and simulation are certainly the most preferred way industries are aligning their software development, debugging, testing, verification and validation. "Simulation results are assisting hardware teams in identifying design issues, thereby reducing iterations. Virtual hardware are also helping support legacy systems, thereby extending the life cycle of products," adds Kumar.

Next-generation system-level EDA tools will incorporate more in-depth knowledge based design know-how

to help engineers at all levels of design expertise to design a switched mode power supply like a power pro. The design tool will complete a design from specifications to schematics and BOM. It should significantly cut design time from a few days/weeks to a few minutes. "This will eventually help achieve 'first time right' design through precise modelling and predicting electronic hardware behaviour to further save or eliminate design iteration efforts, especially on the costly hardware-implementation side," adds Guo. ●



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